

Name: Olivia, Megan, Addie

Date: 3/1/26

Class: Engineering

MyDesign Portfolio

Element A Initial Template

Currently In New York City, the snow on the sidewalks is removed inconsistently and delayed in some cases. The New York City Department of Sanitation clears roads, but property owners are responsible, legally, for cleaning the sidewalks in front of their buildings. ("Sidewalks & Gutters - DSNY")

If the property owners do not clear the snow within a certain number of hours after the snow stops, they can be fined. This system is dysfunctional because it depends on individual property owners. Some clear their sidewalks correctly, while others delay it or don't clear them at all. (Sheridan)The NYCDS only enforces the laws when someone files a complaint. This issue affects millions of New Yorkers who rely on walking every day to get to work, school, or their form of public transportation. According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, falls are one of the leading causes of injury in the U.S, specifically for adults who are older than 65. ("Older Adult Falls Data | Older Adult Fall Prevention")

Snowy and Icy sidewalks increase the risk of slip and fall accidents wich sends thousands of New Yorkers to hospitals each year. ("Injury Prevention in New York State") Snowstorms happen every winter in NYC. This year, we even experienced 2 snowstorms, which were followed by freezing temperatures that created ice on sidewalks. The problem of clearing the snow happens because responsibility is placed on private owners instead of being fully managed publicly by city infrastructure. ("Snow Response - DSNY")

Pedestrians: they need safe sidewalks to walk on every day.

Older people + People with disabilities: They face a high risk of injury from falls

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Property Owners: They are responsible for clearing sidewalks and can face fines if they don't.

This problem is important and needs to be solved now because winter storms happen every year. Newyork City depends heavily on walking and public transportation, and when sidewalks are unsafe, the city's transportation system is disrupted. Slip and fall injuries happen all the time, but they are preventable. This problem affects millions of people every year, so it is crucial to design a better solution.

Works Cited

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